Run a game night with Overlay Studio and ProPresenter

A five-team scoreboard, a prize wheel, score effects and sounds, all dropped on top of your ProPresenter slides and run from a phone. No design skills needed: the Game Night project is ready the moment you open the app.

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1. What you need

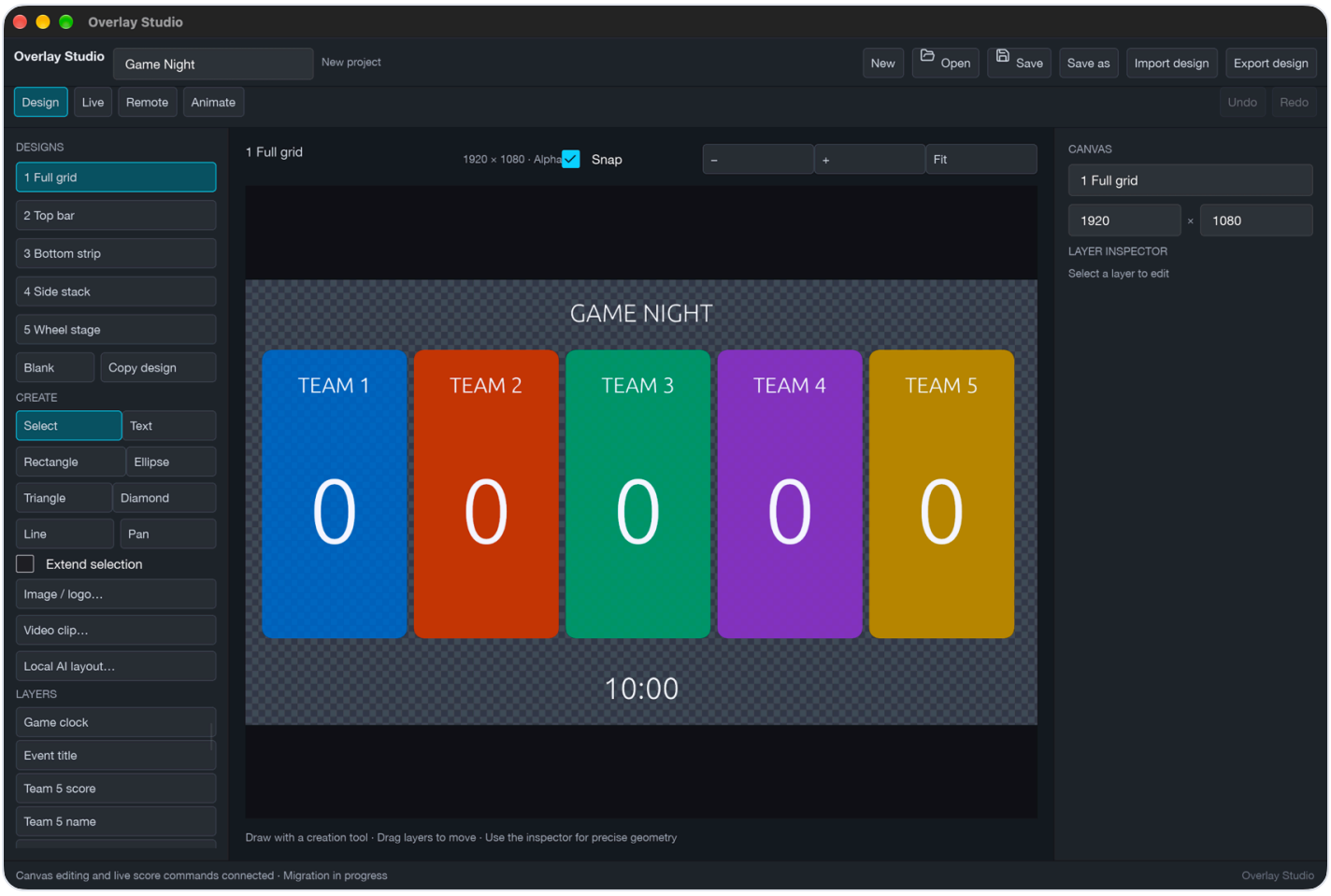
- A Mac running macOS 13 or newer. Overlay Studio and ProPresenter can run on the **same Mac** or on two Macs on the same network.
- ProPresenter 7 or newer (these steps were checked against Renewed Vision's documentation for ProPresenter 20).
- Optional: a phone or iPad on the same Wi-Fi as the Mac, to run the game from the room.
- Optional: your own sound effects (wav, mp3, ogg or flac files).

> **How it works in one sentence**
>
> Overlay Studio draws the scoreboard with a see-through background and sends it over your network as an **NDI** video source; ProPresenter receives that source as a **Video Input** and shows it over your slides.

2. Install Overlay Studio

1. Download **Overlay-Studio.dmg** from the latest release.
2. Open the DMG and drag **Overlay Studio** into **Applications**.
3. Open it. If macOS says it cannot verify the app, right-click the app, choose **Open**, then **Open** again. You only do this once.
4. If macOS asks to allow **local network** access, click **Allow**. NDI and the phone remote need it.

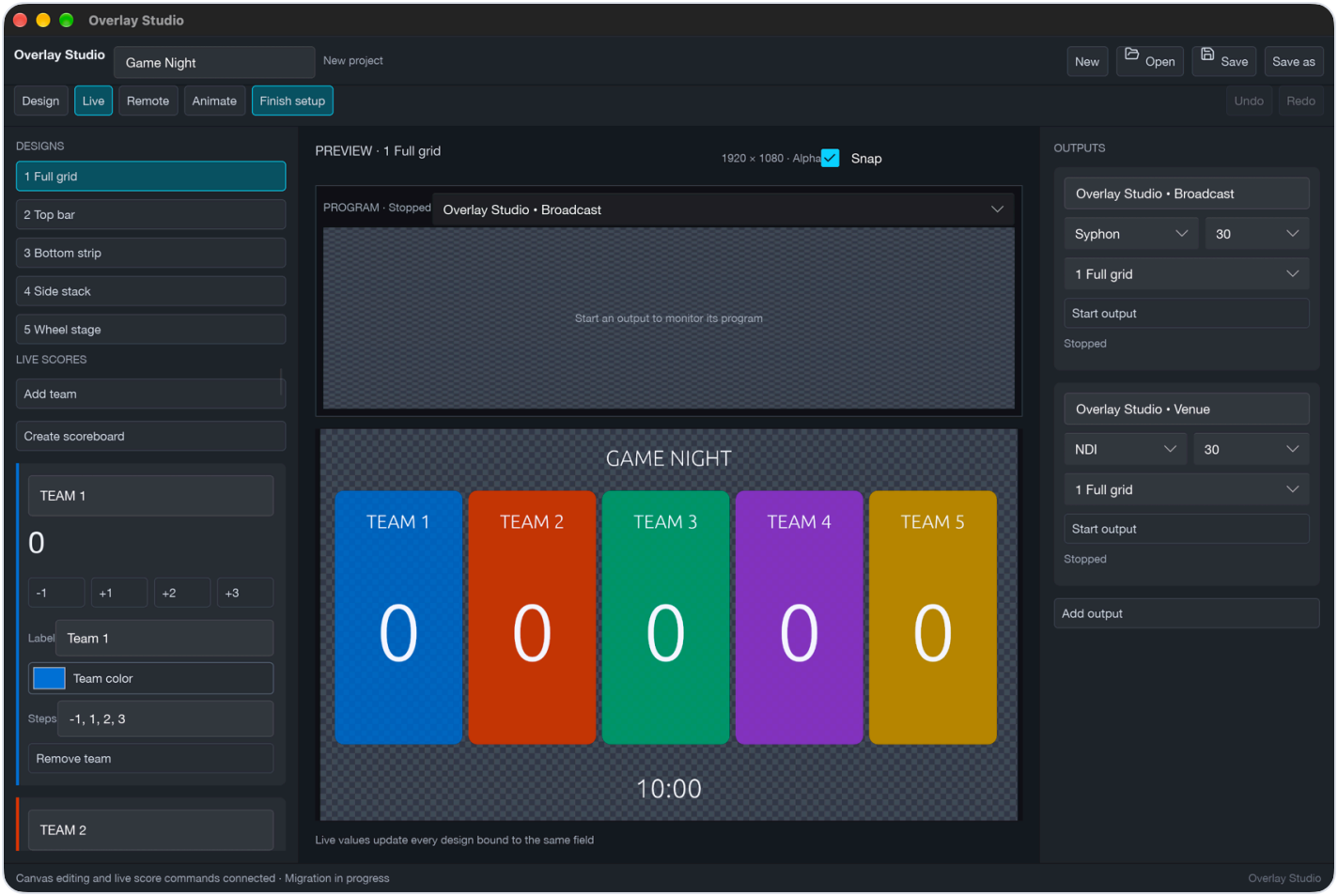
The app opens on a ready-made project called **Game Night**: five teams, five layouts, a clock and a prize wheel.



The Design tab. You do not need it on game night; the five layouts are already built.

3. Name your teams

1. Click the **Live** tab, then **Game setup** (it becomes **Finish setup**).
2. For each team change the **Label** (the name shown on screen), pick a **Team color**, and check the **Steps** (the score buttons, for example `-1, 1, 2, 3`).
3. Click **Finish setup**. Team colors recolor all five layouts at once.
4. Choose **Save as** and keep the file, for example *Friday Game Night.overlay*, so you can reopen it next time.



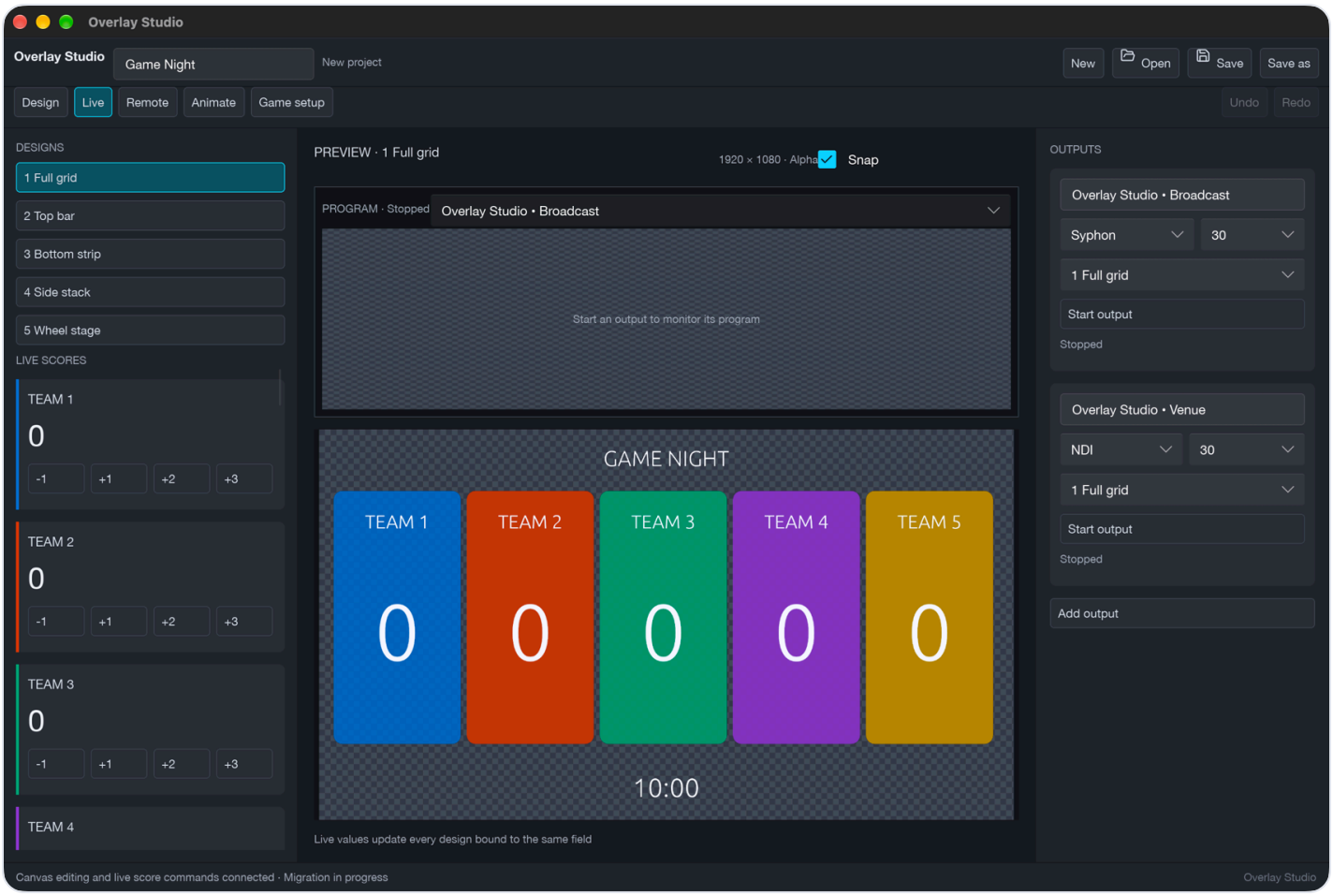
Game setup: label, color and score steps for each team.

4. Start the NDI output

An **output** is a channel that sends the picture out of Overlay Studio. You will start one as NDI.

1. In **Live**, look at the **Outputs** column on the right. The first output is **Overlay Studio • Broadcast**. Change its protocol dropdown from **Syphon** to **NDI**.

2. Check the layout dropdown (for example **1 Full grid**), then click **Start output**. The status changes from *Stopped* to sending.
3. Click **Take design** to put the chosen layout on the output.



The Live tab: layouts on the left, preview in the middle, outputs on the right.

> **Why the first output?**
>
> The phone's *Show…* buttons always switch the **first** output. If you leave that one on Syphon and send NDI from the second output (**Overlay Studio • Venue**), the phone will change a layout ProPresenter is not receiving. Using the first output for NDI avoids this.

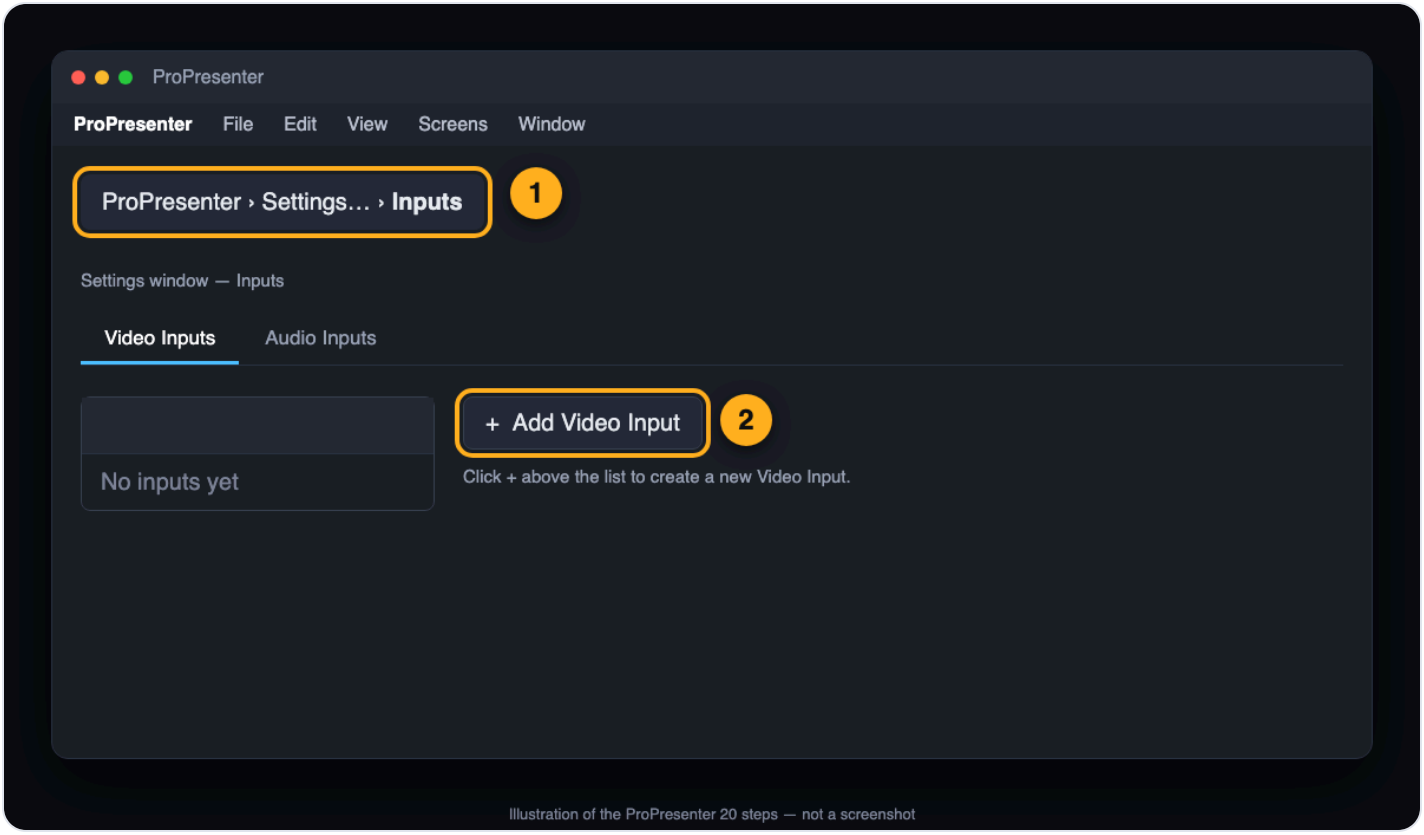
Hide sends a fully see-through picture without stopping the output. It is the quick way to clear the scoreboard from the screens.

5. Bring it into ProPresenter

Do this once, then every game night only needs steps 4 and 6.

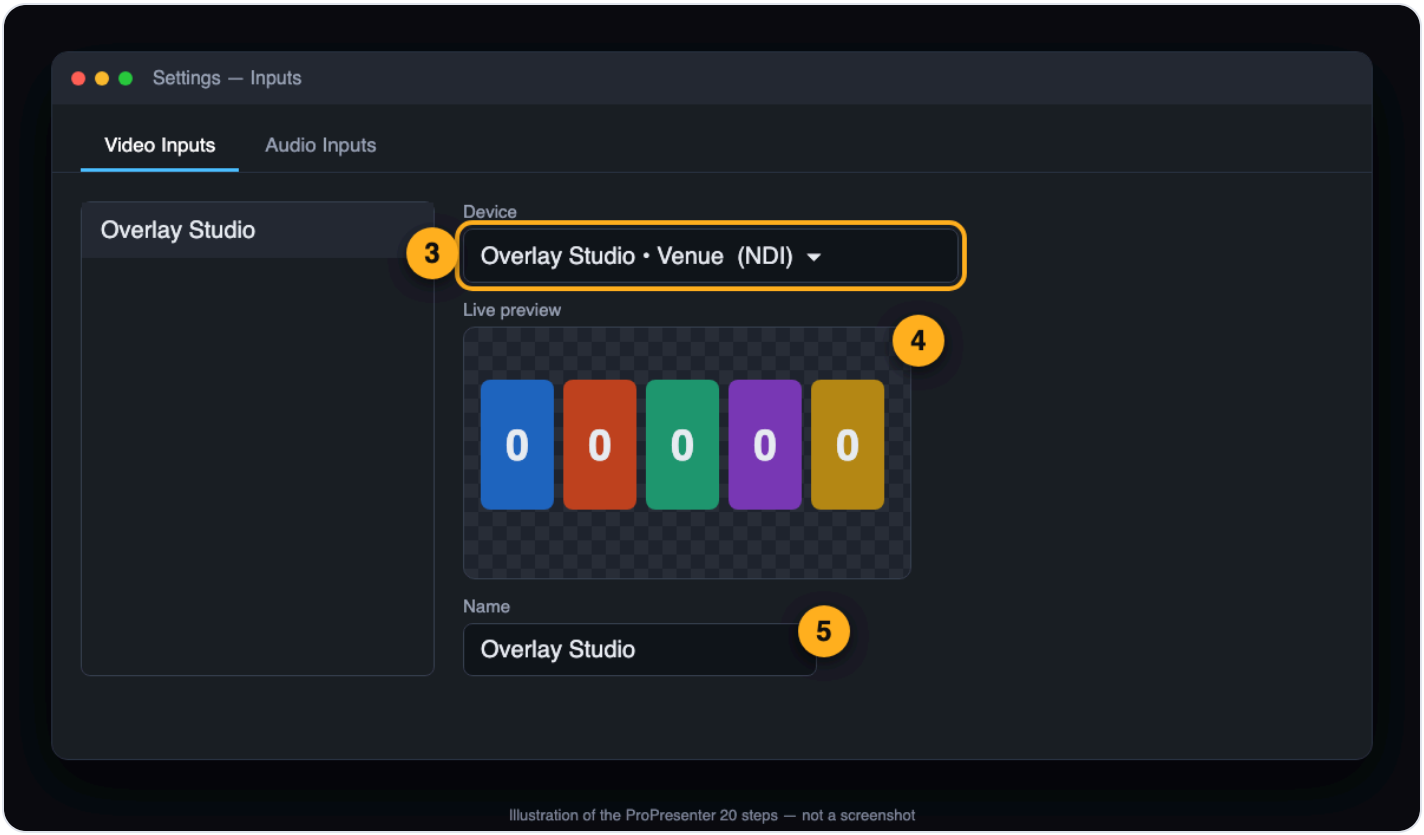
Add the input

1. Leave Overlay Studio's NDI output running.
2. In ProPresenter open **ProPresenter › Settings › Inputs** and choose the **Video Inputs** tab.
3. Click **+** above **Add Video Input**.



Settings › Inputs › Video Inputs. (Illustration of the steps, not a screenshot of ProPresenter.)

4. Select the new input, open the **Device** dropdown and choose the **Overlay Studio • Broadcast** NDI source. Its name usually starts with your Mac's name.
5. A live preview of the scoreboard should appear. If it asks for a resolution and frame rate, choose **1920×1080** and **30**.
6. Give it a name you will recognize, such as **Overlay Studio**.

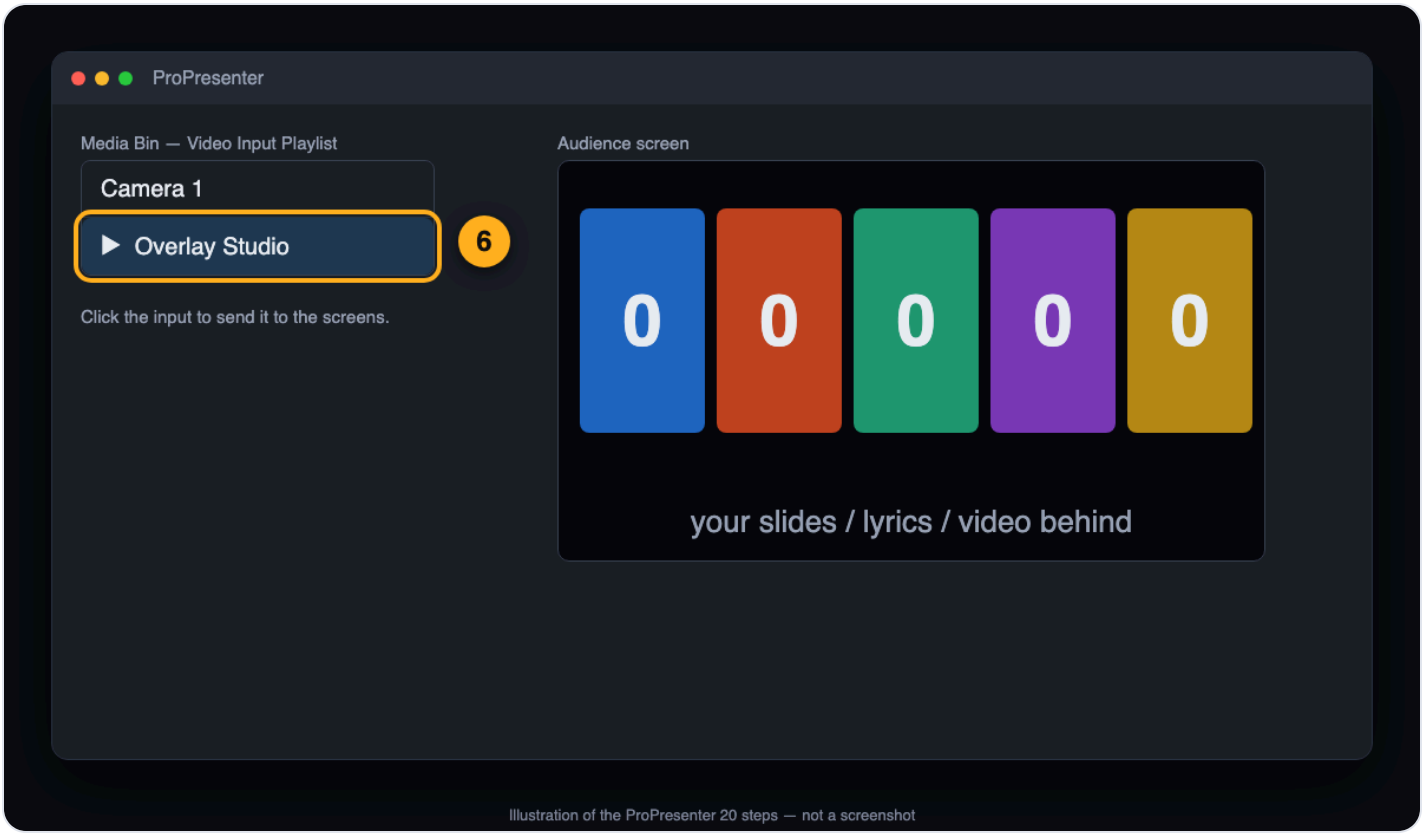


Pick the Overlay Studio NDI source and check the live preview. (Illustration.)

> **Source not in the list?**
> Same Mac for both apps: open the **NDI Input Discovery** settings in ProPresenter and turn on **Show Sources running on the local machine**. Separate Macs: make sure both are on the same network and subnet. More in If something goes wrong.

Show it on the screens

7. In the Media Bin open the **Video Input Playlist** and click **Overlay Studio**. Your scoreboard appears on the audience screens.
8. You can also add it as a **Video Input Action** on a slide or macro, or as a **Video Input** element in the Slide Editor, so it appears when you click that slide.



Trigger the input from the Video Input Playlist. (Illustration.)

> **Layering: rehearse this once**
>
> ProPresenter draws a Video Input on its own *Video Input layer*, which sits **below** the Slide layer. A slide with a background or text can cover it. For a scoreboard that sits on top of slides, put it on the slide as a **Video Input element** (Slide Editor) or use slides without a background, and run through it before the event. Renewed Vision describes the layers in *ProPresenter Output Layers*.

> **Edges look dark or fringed?**
>
> Overlay Studio sends see-through areas (alpha). If you see a dark outline, open the input in **Settings › Inputs** and untick **Premultiplied** for that input (see Renewed Vision's *Premultiplied and Straight Keying*).

6. Run the night

All of this happens in Overlay Studio's **Live** tab.

Pick a layout

Click a layout under **Designs**, then **Take design** to put it on the output. Or use the **Show...** buttons on the phone.

Layout	Use it when
1 Full grid	Introductions and the big reveal: all five teams, large scores and the clock.
2 Top bar	During a round, keeping the middle of the screen free for questions or video.
3 Bottom strip	Lyrics, trivia slides or video above, scores along the bottom.
4 Side stack	Slides on the right, scores stacked down the left.
5 Wheel stage	The prize wheel in the middle with team scores along the bottom.

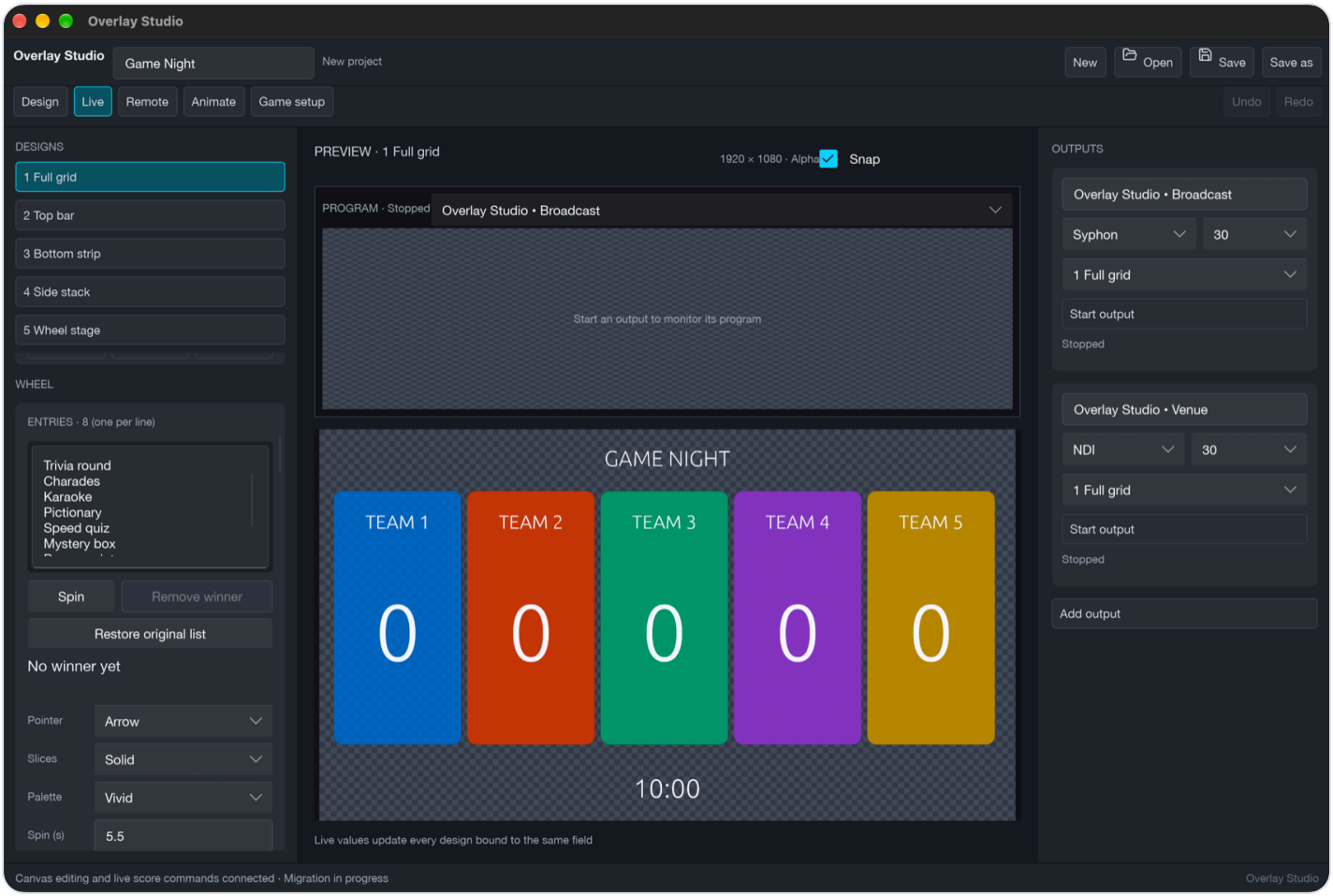
Keep score and time

- Under **Live scores** every team has buttons (for example `−1` `+1` `+2` `+3`). Click once per change; the number updates on screen at once.
- Under **Clocks** use **Start**, **Reset** and the `−10s` `+10s` `+60s` buttons for the game clock.
- A wrong click? Use **Undo** at the top right.

7. The prize wheel

1. In **Live** scroll the left column to **Wheel**. Type your choices into **Entries**, one per line (it starts with ideas like Trivia round and Charades).
2. Click **5 Wheel stage**, then **Take design**.
3. Click **Spin**. The wheel turns, slows and lands; the winner's name shows above it.
4. Click **Remove winner** to take that entry off so it cannot be picked twice. **Restore original list** puts every entry back.

Under the buttons you can change the **Pointer** style, **Slices** style, **Palette**, spin time in seconds and confetti.

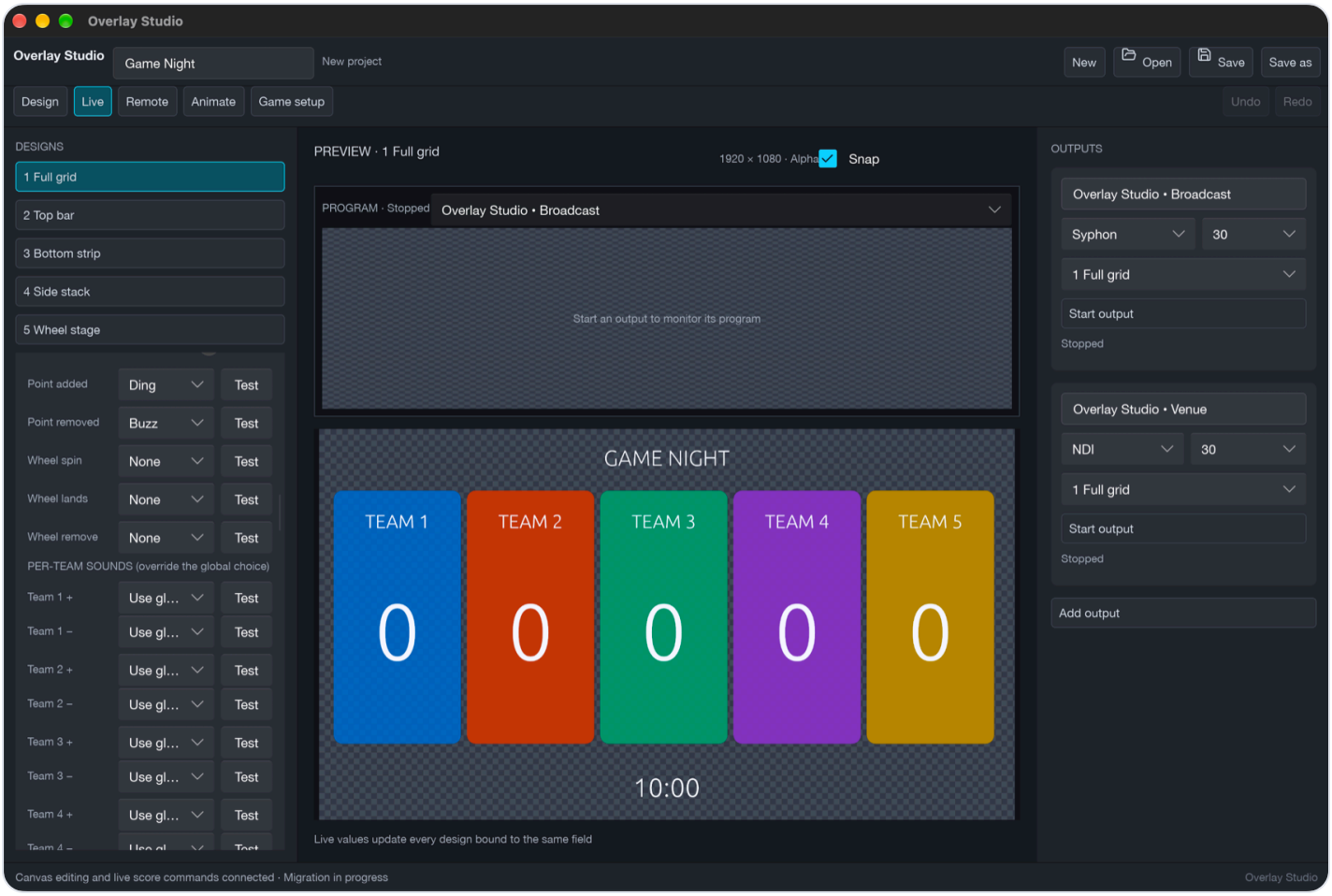


The Wheel panel in the Live tab.

8. Score effects and sounds

Every point added tints that team's tiles **green**, every point removed tints them **black**, then they ease back. Each layout has its own style (flash and pop, sweep, wipe, shake or sparkle burst). In **Live › Effects and sound** you can:

- Choose the colors, how long the effect lasts and the overall volume.
- Pick the sound for **Point added**, **Point removed**, **Wheel spin**, **Wheel lands** and **Wheel remove**. Press **Test** next to each to hear it.
- Give a team its own sound under **Per-team sounds** (it overrides the global choice).
- Import your own wav, mp3, ogg or flac files. Imported sounds are saved inside the project file.

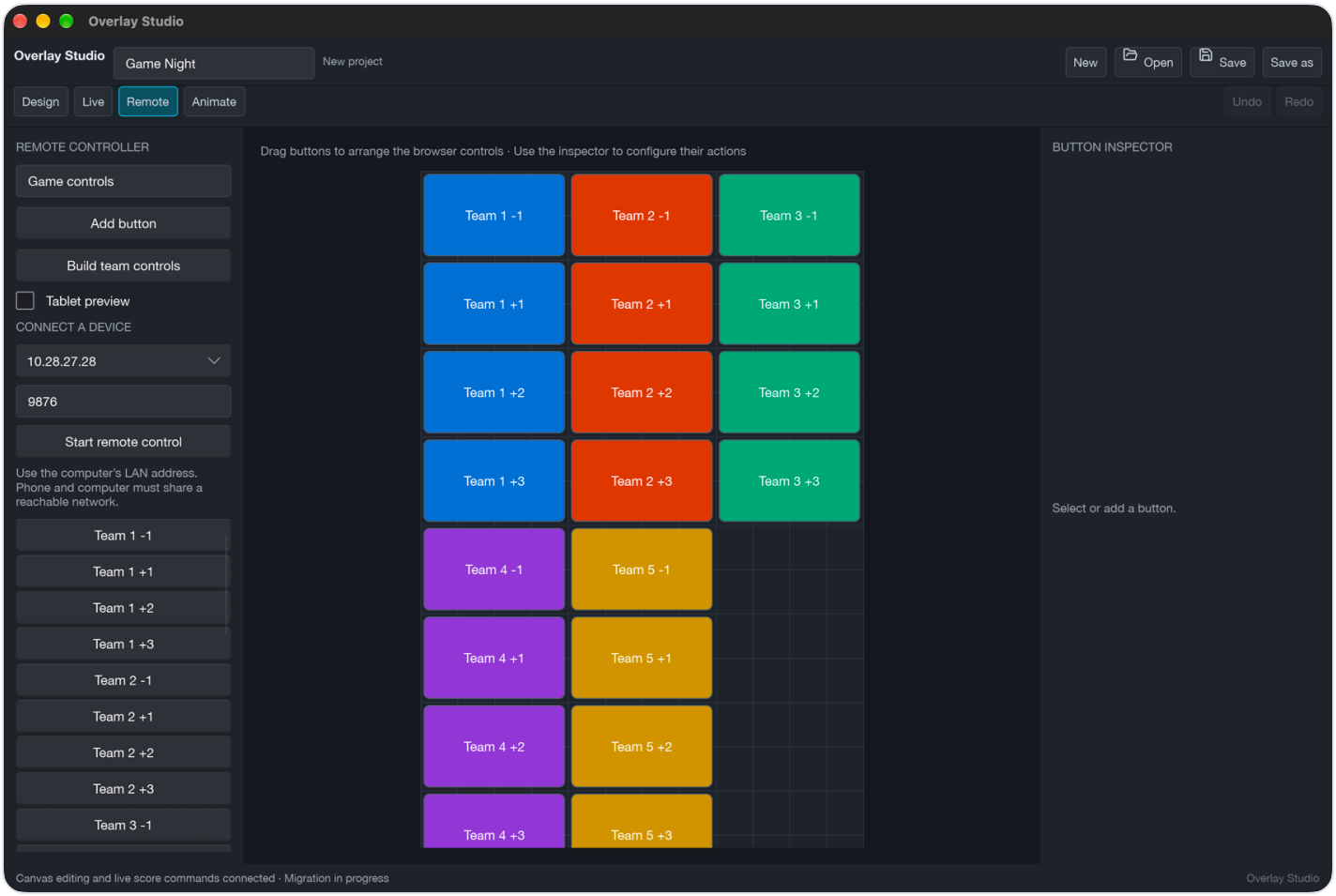


Sound pickers and per-team overrides.

> **Where the sound comes out**
>
> Overlay Studio plays sounds from the Mac it runs on, through that Mac's normal audio output. NDI carries the picture only. Connect that Mac's audio output to your sound system (or mixer) and test it before doors open.

9. Control it from a phone

1. Click the **Remote** tab. The default **Game controls** layout already has score buttons for all five teams, plus **Show...** for each layout, **Spin wheel**, **Remove winner** and **Restore wheel**.
2. Pick the Mac's network address in **Connect a device** (use the one on your Wi-Fi) and click **Start remote control**.
3. On the phone, join the **same Wi-Fi** and scan the QR code that appears in the app. The controller opens in the phone's browser.



The Remote tab: the button layout is what appears on the phone.

Venue Wi-Fi that blocks devices from talking to each other (client isolation) will stop pairing. A small travel router for the media team solves it.

10. If something goes wrong

Problem	Try this
ProPresenter does not list the NDI source	Check the output says it is sending. Same Mac: enable **Show Sources running on the local machine** under NDI Input Discovery. Separate Macs: same network and subnet, wired if you can. Reopen the Device dropdown.
Scoreboard shows in ProPresenter but is hidden behind slides	See the layering note in section 5: use a Video Input element on the slide, or slides without a background.

Dark edges around the graphics	Untick **Premultiplied** for that input in Settings › Inputs.
Phone buttons change nothing on screen	The phone controls the **first** output. Make sure that output is the one sending NDI (section 4).
Phone will not pair	Same Wi-Fi as the Mac, and click **Start remote control** first. Check the Mac allowed local network access.
No sound	Press **Test** in Effects and sound. Check the Mac's output device and volume. Overlay Studio retries the audio device if it was unplugged.
You quit by accident	Reopen the app. It offers to **recover** unsaved work.

Sources: Renewed Vision — Setting Up A Video Input in ProPresenter, NDI Input Discovery, NDI Troubleshooting, ProPresenter Output Layers, Premultiplied and Straight Keying.

11. Pre-show checklist

Print this page (`Cmd` + `P`) or keep it on a phone.

☐ Team names, colors and score steps set; project saved.

☐ First output set to **NDI**, started, and a layout taken.

☐ ProPresenter shows the **Overlay Studio** input with a live preview.

☐ Scoreboard appears **over** a test slide on the audience screen.

☐ Clock starts, stops and resets.

☐ Press **+1** for a team: the tiles flash green and the sound plays through the room speakers.

☐ Wheel entries typed in; one test spin, then **Restore original list**.

☐ Phone paired; **Show...** and **Spin wheel** buttons work.

☐ Scores reset to 0 and clock reset before doors open.

☐ A second person knows how to **Hide** the scoreboard in an emergency.